

Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A 2
♥ Q 9 8 3
♦ 7 6 5 3
♣ 10 9 7

♠ K Q 9 8 6 4
♥ A J 2
♦ 8
♣ 6 5 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 7
♥ 10 7 5 4
♦ A 9 4 2
♣ K Q J 3

♠ J 10 5 3
♥ K 6
♦ K Q J 10
♣ A 8 2

West	North	East	South
			1 ♦
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	2 ♠
Pass	4 ♠		
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			

North is to play 4 ♠. East leads the ♣K.

Losers: ♠=1 ♥=0 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 4

The ♣ lead was terrible for you as it exposes your 2 ♣ losers before you can establish a ♦ for a discard. If you start to pull trumps now the defense will grab their ♠A, their 2 ♣s and their ♦A.

If you try to establish a ♦ they will do the same thing, just in a different order. What does that leave you?

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It leaves you trying the only possible way you can make this contract, finessing West for the ♥Q to get a ♣ discard from dummy.

You win the ♣A in dummy, play the ♥K, then return a ♥ to your ♥J. You then discard a ♣ from dummy on the ♥A.

When you have only one chance to make your contract you take it.

This time it worked, another time it might not.

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q J 10 9
 ♥ Q J 8
 ♦ 6 5 2
 ♣ 8 4 3

♠ K 8 6 4 2

♥ -

♦ J 10 7 3

♣ Q J 10 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ -

♥ A K 9 6 5 4 2

♦ A Q 4

♣ K 7 5

♠ A 7 5 3

♥ 10 7 3

♦ K 9 8

♣ A 9 6

West

North

East

South

Pass

1♥

Pass

2♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by East

♠. Now play the ♠Q and when North plays low, discard a ♣. This is a loser on loser play and South takes the trick with the ♠A.

South now leads the ♥7. You cover with dummy's ♥8 knowing the finesse will win. Next you play dummy's ♠J, covered by North and ruffed by you (if North didn't cover you would throw another ♣ loser). Now enter dummy with the ♥Q, pulling South's last trump at the same time. Discard your 2 ♣s on the ♠ 10 9 and try the ♦ finesse for an overtrick.

This loser-on-loser play didn't have much to do with trump management.

Just the fact that you had to use the trump suit for entries to dummy, and therefore couldn't immediately pull trumps.

East is to play 4♥. South leads the ♥3.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=3 Total = 5

If North has the ♦K, one ♦ loser can be eliminated by a finesse. And, if North also has the ♣A one more loser can be eliminated by leading toward your ♣K. The chance of both cards being held by North isn't very good, only about 25%. But dummy has some nice ♠s. Can you use them?

Yes, you can establish 2 ♠ winners for discards, and most importantly, you can do it without letting North into the lead. This is important because if North gets in and plays a ♣ through your ♣ K 7 5 it might be a disaster.

So win the ♥J in dummy. Uh-Oh, North discards a

Board 5

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 3
 ♥ K Q J 7
 ♦ 10 6 4
 ♣ A J 10 7

♠ K 6

♥ 8 5 4 2

♦ K 8 7 2

♣ 9 5 4



♠ 10 5 2
 ♥ 10 9 3
 ♦ J 9 5 3
 ♣ K Q 8

♠ A Q J 9 7 4

♥ A 6

♦ A Q

♣ 6 3 2

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1 ♠
Pass	1NT	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			

4 ♠ by South

... except when you have a good reason not to, like here.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=0 ♣=3 Total = 4

This is a very easy problem to be up here at number 18! Clearly you have to discard one of those 4 losers on the only card dummy has, the ♦ K.

Just as clearly you have to be able to enter dummy after you unblock the ♦ A Q so you can't pull trumps immediately.

So here's the Plan. Win the ♥ A. Pull one round of trumps with the ♠ A. Play the ♦ A Q to get them out of the way. Enter dummy with the ♠ K. Play the ♦ K, discard a loser, and hope nobody ruffs.

Just remember to always pull trumps immediately . . .